LessonPlan Career Roadmap

Hospitality, Aviation and Maritime (Hotels, Pilot, Cabin Crew, Merchant Navy): Class 6 to Career

LESSONPLAN CAREER ROADMAP
Compiled from publicly available sources. Items marked † should be confirmed on the official notification of the conducting body. Dates and rules change every year.

1. Pathway overview

Stage	When	Key decision	What it unlocks
Foundation	Class 6-8	Build English, communication, geography and teamwork; explore travel and service interests	Language and soft skills used in all three fields
Pre-board	Class 9-10	Keep Maths and Science strong for pilot, aircraft maintenance and marine engineering	Keeps PCM-based options open
Stream choice	After Class 10	Hospitality: any stream with English. Pilot / AME / Marine: PCM. Cabin crew: any stream	NCHM JEE, IGRUA, AME CET, IMU CET eligibility
Preparation	Class 11-12	Boards + NCHM JEE, IMU CET, flying school tests; fitness and medical readiness	Seats in hotel management, flying, maritime programmes
Degree / training	After Class 12	BSc Hospitality, CPL pilot training, AME, cabin crew courses, BSc Nautical Science, BTech Marine	Industry licences and sea or flying time
Career	After training	Hotels and tourism, airlines and airports, shipping and ports	See section 7

2. Stage-by-stage nodes

Class 6-10: Foundation

- Decision: build English, Hindi, communication, geography and teamwork. Try scouts, NCC, sports, school hospitality or travel clubs.
- For pilot, aircraft engineer and marine roles: keep Physics, Maths and fitness strong; medical and eyesight standards are strict.†

After Class 10: Stream choice

- Hospitality (NCHM JEE): Class 12 in any stream with English.
- Pilot (CPL): Physics and Maths in Class 12 is the long-standing rule; DGCA was reported to remove the requirement for Commerce and Arts students if they complete a bridge course, but sources conflict on whether this is notified.†
- Aircraft Maintenance Engineer (AME): Class 12 PCM or an engineering diploma after Class 10; AME CET for entry to approved colleges.†
- Marine (IMU CET): PCM with minimum marks in English.
- Karnataka note: Class 11-12 is the 2-year Pre-University Course (PUC) after SSLC; CBSE/ICSE schools run Class 11-12 directly.

Class 11-12: Preparation

- Hospitality: apply to NCHM JEE (April), then counselling in May-June; or apply directly to private hotel management schools.
- Pilot: apply to flying schools and IGRUA (entrance around May); start medical checks early (DGCA Class 1 medical).†
- Maritime: IMU CET (May) after Class 12; medical and eyesight checks are important.

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After Class 12: Training

- BSc Hospitality and Hotel Administration (3 yr), BHM (4 yr), culinary and tourism courses.
- CPL ground exams and flying hours; or integrated pilot programmes at flying academies.
- BSc Nautical Science, BTech Marine Engineering, other IMU courses; DG Shipping approved courses.

Career

- Hotels, resorts, cruise lines, airlines, airports, ships and ports, tourism and events; supervisory and management growth with experience.

3. Early preparation (Class 6-12)

Exam / route	Conducted by	Classes	Details	Timing
Scouts, NCC, sports, school clubs	Schools and NCC Directorate	6-12	Teamwork, discipline and fitness	Through the year
English and communication competitions	Schools and NGOs	6-12	Builds service and customer skills	Through the year
NMMS (scholarship test)	Karnataka DSERT / KSEAB	8	Single written test	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb

Tip for parents: pilot and marine careers have strict medical, eyesight and physical standards. Check these requirements early with the training institute.

4. Entrance exams and licences

NCHM JEE (Hotel Management) - NTA	
Conducting body	NTA for the National Council for Hotel Management; exams.nta.nic.in/nchm-jee
Used for	BSc in Hospitality and Hotel Administration at NCHM-affiliated Institutes of Hotel Management (IHM), including IHM Bangalore
Eligibility	10+2 with English; no age limit; appearing candidates can apply; no stream restriction stated (inferred)†
Frequency / dates	Once a year; 2026 exam on 25 April (CBT, 120 cities); registration extended to 1 April; counselling around 31 May - 3 June†
Pattern	Computer-based; duration reported as 3 hours, though one source gives 11 am - 1 pm; section-wise breakdown not confirmed†

Hotel management in Bengaluru (examples)	
IHM Bangalore	BSc Hospitality and Hotel Administration, 3 years (6 semesters); about 285 seats (reported); entry via NCHM JEE counselling; fees reported between about 3.7 lakh and 7.2 lakh total, sources conflict†
MS Ramaiah College of Hotel Management	Four-year BHM; 45% in Class 12 and valid RUAS AT or CUET-UG marks (reported); about 1.79 lakh per year†
IIHM Bangalore	Three-year BA with the University of West London via the e-CHAT test (reported)†

Pilot: CPL, IGRUA and flying schools	
Licence	Commercial Pilot Licence (CPL) from DGCA after ground exams and flying hours; Class 1 medical; minimum age 18 (standard)†
Eligibility	IGRUA prospectus: 10+2 with Physics, Maths and English, 50% aggregate; another IGRUA page says 50% in each of English, Physics and Maths (45% for SC/ST/OBC/EWS). Sources conflict†
DGCA rule change	Reports from May 2025: Physics and Maths no longer required for Commerce and Arts students who complete an approved NIOS bridge course; another report says only proposed†

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IGRUA entrance	Indira Gandhi Rashtriya Uran Akademi, Amethi; 2026 entrance on 3 May 2026 (applications until 13 April); application fee 10,000 or 12,000 by source†
Cost and time	CPL training cost and duration not confirmed at the time of compilation†

Cabin crew, airport ground staff and AME	
Cabin crew	Class 12 pass; fluent English and Hindi (and often a local language); minimum height about 155 cm (reported); age bands vary 18-32 or 19-35 by airline†
Airport ground staff	Class 12 pass; English and Hindi; minimum age 18-20 depending on employer†
Aircraft Maintenance Engineer (AME)	Class 12 PCM or engineering diploma after Class 10; AME CET; DGCA CAR 147 approved organisations†

IMU CET (Indian Maritime University Common Entrance Test)	
Conducting body	Indian Maritime University (IMU); imu.edu.in
Used for	BTech Marine Engineering, BSc Nautical Science, and other maritime courses
Eligibility	10+2 with 60% aggregate in Physics, Chemistry and Maths and 50% in English in Class 10 and 12 (reported); age limits and Nautical Science specifics not confirmed†
Frequency / dates	Once a year; 2026 exam on 24 May 2026 (CBT); application deadline reported as 24 or 28 April 2026†
Pattern	BTech paper reported as 200 MCQs across Physics, Chemistry, Maths, English and General Aptitude, about 3 hours†

Other routes

Route	For	Key details
DG Shipping approved courses and sponsorships	Deck and engine officer cadets	Approved pre-sea training, company sponsorship, sea time†
GP Rating and other post-Class 10 maritime courses	After Class 10	Not researched at the time of compilation†
Aerospace Engineering (BTech)	After Class 12 PCM	See Science PCM document; JEE Main / KCET
Tourism, travel and events degrees	After Class 12	University or private institute tests†

Postgraduate and beyond (preview)

Exam	Body	For	Tentative timing
ATPL and instructor ratings	DGCA / flying schools	Airline captain and instructor roles	After CPL and hours†
IMU PG and Master Mariner exams	IMU / DG Shipping	Senior sea and shore roles	After sea time†
MBA in Hospitality / Aviation / Shipping	IIMs and others	Management roles	CAT and university tests†

5. Scholarships and financial support

Scholarship	Provider	Who can apply	Amount	Window
Sponsorship and bank loan schemes for pilot and maritime training	Banks, companies, shipping lines	Selected cadets	Varies	Per programme†

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Scholarship	Provider	Who can apply	Amount	Window
NMMS	Govt. of India via Karnataka DSERT	Class 8 in govt/aided/local body schools; family income up to 3.5 lakh; at least 55% in Class 7 (50% SC/ST)†	12,000 per year (1,000 per month), Class 9-12	Apply Sep-Oct; exam Jan-Feb
CSSS (Central Sector Scheme)	Ministry of Education via National Scholarship Portal	Top 20% of successful candidates in own board and stream; family income up to 4.5 lakh	12,000 per year for UG years 1-3; 20,000 per year for years 4-5 / PG	2026-27 portal opened 1 Jun 2026; one listing shows 31 Oct 2026 deadline†
Post-matric scholarships	National Scholarship Portal and Karnataka SSP	SC/ST/OBC/minority categories, income limits	Varies	Typically Jul-Nov†

Note: pilot and maritime training can be expensive; check loan, sponsorship and scholarship options before enrolling.†

6. Courses, training and institutions

Course / programme	Duration	Entry	Note
BSc Hospitality and Hotel Administration	3 yr	NCHM JEE	Hotels, airlines, cruise, events
BHM / BA Hospitality (private)	3-4 yr	College tests, CUET, RUAS AT	Management track
CPL pilot programmes	1.5-3 yr	Flying school / IGRUA entrance	DGCA CPL; medical Class 1
AME / Aerospace diploma / BTech	3-4 yr	AME CET, JEE, KCET	Aircraft maintenance and engineering
Cabin crew and ground handling courses	6 months - 1 yr	Institute interviews and airline recruitment	English and personality skills
BSc Nautical Science / BTech Marine Engineering	3-4 yr	IMU CET	DG Shipping approved

Examples of institutions (illustrative, not a ranking): IHM Bangalore, MS Ramaiah College of Hotel Management, IGRUA (Amethi), Indian Maritime University campuses, DGCA-approved flying clubs, AME colleges.†

7. Career outcomes

Path	Job roles	Higher study / growth
Hospitality	Hotel manager, chef, front office, F&B, event manager, cruise hospitality	MBA Hospitality, culinary specialisation
Aviation (flying)	Commercial pilot, first officer, captain, flight instructor	ATPL, type ratings
Aviation (ground and cabin)	Cabin crew, airport ground staff, ticketing, customer service	Supervisory roles, airline management
Aircraft engineering	Aircraft maintenance engineer, avionics technician	DGCA licences, BTech Aerospace
Maritime	Deck officer, engineer officer, ship manager, port and shipping logistics	Master Mariner, MBA Shipping

8. Related umbrellas this one connects to

- Science PCM: pilot, AME and marine engineering need PCM (see Science PCM document).
- Defence: Navy and Air Force careers overlap with merchant navy and aviation (see Defence document).
- Commerce and Management: hotel, airline and shipping management roles (see Commerce document).
- Skills and Entrepreneurship: restaurants, travel start-ups and events (see Skills and Entrepreneurship document).

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ONE-PAGE GIST: Hospitality, Aviation and Maritime

Items marked † are subject to confirmation against official notifications.

Stage	What to do
Class 6-10	Build English, teamwork, fitness; keep Maths and Science strong for pilot and marine
After Class 10	Hospitality: any stream with English. Pilot / AME / Marine: PCM; PUC in Karnataka
Class 11-12	Boards + NCHM JEE, IGRUA / flying school tests, IMU CET; medicals
After Class 12	BSc Hospitality; CPL pilot; AME; cabin crew; BSc Nautical / BTech Marine
Training	Industry licences, flying hours, sea time, internships
Career	Hotel manager, pilot, cabin crew, AME, deck / engine officer, port and shipping roles

Exam / route	When	Pattern / key point	Marking
NCHM JEE	April (2026: 25 Apr)	CBT; 10+2 with English; BSc HHA at IHMs	Check bulletin
IGRUA entrance	May (2026: 3 May)	10+2 PCM-English, 50%; pilot training	Check prospectus
IMU CET	May (2026: 24 May)	CBT; 60% PCM + 50% English; marine courses	Check notification
AME CET	Yearly†	PCM or diploma; DGCA-approved colleges	Check notification
Cabin crew	Airline recruitment	Class 12, English / Hindi, height about 155 cm	Interview-based

Key rules: pilot and marine need Physics, Maths and strict medicals; hotel management accepts all streams.†

Scholarships: NMMS (Class 8), CSSS (UG), loans and sponsorships for pilot / marine.†

Careers: hotel manager, chef, pilot, cabin crew, aircraft engineer, merchant navy officer.

Want a personalised roadmap or counselling? Contact LessonPlan, Yelahanka, Bangalore.

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